

Gelbach decomposition of age gradient

Federal income tax should be more progressive (Own survey, 2025)

92.0% explained, $\beta_{short} = -0.111$, $\beta_{full} = -0.009$, $N = 2,413$

tier 2 candidate variables: beliefs, worldview/values, position

#	Item	Contribution	% of explained
1	people get rich at others' expense, not by creating value	-0.042	41.4%
2	DEI creates opportunity for some at others' expense	-0.019	18.9%
3	employment status: not in labor force	0.015	-14.8%
4	missing-value indicator: expected household income in 10 years	-0.010	9.4%
5	CEO pay gains came at expense of average workers	-0.009	8.8%
6	higher taxes on high incomes make people work less	0.009	-8.4%
7	perceived risk of relocating due to climate events (10yr)	-0.007	6.8%
8	expected household income in 10 years	-0.006	5.8%
9	harder or easier to move up now vs. parents' day	-0.006	5.4%
10	household income needed to live comfortably now	0.005	-5.2%

— 54 items with <5% contribution omitted —